artillery could not deploy any forward observation posts, as they did not have radio sets for the observers to control and guide the guns. At the same time, the Chinese were clearly visible, coming and going in large numbers. On 17 October, twelve Chinese 82-mm mortars had been dug in and deployed opposite Bridge 4. To make matters worse, having been forced to occupy defensive positions at the base of the Tsangdhar, practically on the riverfront itself, the men would have nowhere to go after their limited ammunition ran out.

In the crisp cold air of the night, watching the campfires lit by the Chinese on the other side of the Nam Ka Chu, Gurdial Singh felt a wave of anger. No stranger to battle, Guru fumed at the arrogance of the Chinese, who he felt were laughing at the Indians. Having been away on leave, the major had done everything he could to rejoin the battalion just four days ago. Shocked by the near suicidal deployment, he had been visiting the various 2 Rajput positions on the Nam Ka Chu. He was amazed at the incompetence of the senior officers who had insisted on stringing the troops out along the river. From their observation posts, the Chinese had been watching 7 Brigade walk into a carefully laid trap. He was experienced and pragmatic enough to realize that if the Chinese attacked now, not just 2 Rajput, but every other unit would be annihilated.

Gurdial Singh, a clean-shaven Sikh, was originally from 3 Rajput and had replaced Major Brahmanand Avasthy as the battalion's 2IC at Walong. His arrival in 2 Rajput had had an electrifying effect on the battalion, for in the Rajput regimental circle, Gurdial Singh was a living legend. During the 1947-48 Jammu and Kashmir Operations, he had taken a company of Gujjars from 3 Rajput up to the Tain Dhar Ridge near Naushera in support of 1 Rajput's defensive positions that were being attacked by Pakistani raiders. In spite of heavy casualties, the raiders had managed to get past the barbed wire into a picket that originally contained twenty-seven men, of whom twenty-four were either dead or severely wounded. The three surviving men valiantly took on the intruders in a hand-to-hand fight. Two more defenders fell, but the last man, Naik Jadunath Singh, continued to defy the enemy. The few vital minutes gained by this valiant action allowed Gurdial Singh's company to reach the post and regain the position after a desperate battle. If the company had not reached the picket when it did, the Tain Dhar feature would have been overrun and holding Naushera would have been impossible.